A-A-51875A
5 June 1989
SUPERSEDING
A-A-0051875(DM)
20 May 1987

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION

HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, DELICATE JAWS

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description.

This commercial item description a curved suture needle holder with delicate jaws suitable for use in general and eye surgical procedures.

Salient characteristics:

General. The holder shall be a curved suture needle holder used to hold very fine needles and sutures in general and eye surgery.

Material. The suture needle holder shall be fabricated from Class 4 martensitic corrosion-resisting steel in accordance with American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Designation F899.

Hardness. The suture needle holder shall have a Rockwell Hardness C scale (HRC) of 40 to 47 in accordance with ASTM Designations E18 or E92 whichever is applicable. Conversion of hardness values shall be in accordance with ASTM Designation E140.

Characteristics. The holder shall be a curved suture needle holder, 134 mm long with 9 mm jaws which are not serrated. The handles shall be knurled and rounded and have a locking mechanism. The suture needle holder shall be in accordance with Defense Personnel Support Center (DPSC) Drawing No. 23349.

Finish. The suture needle holder shall be mirror, satin, or mirror and satin. Should the holder have a mirror finish, the interior surfaces need not have a mirror finish.

Passivation. The suture needle holder shall be passivated.

Corrosion-resistance. The suture needle holder shall show no sign of corrosion or copper plating when tested in accordance with ASTM Designation F1089.

AMSC N/A FSC 6515

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Jaws and locking mechanism. The suture needle holder shall be designed to hold very fine sutures and needles without having to lock the holder. The jaws, when closed, shall hold sutures between 0.020 and 0.050 mm in diameter. When open, the locking mechanism shall not be engaged. The jaws shall be fine and smooth with rounded joints and sharp edges. When tested as specified herein, the locking mechanism shall engage easily and the jaws shall close completely.

Identification marking and labeling. The suture needle holder shall bear the contractor's name or registered trademark and the word "stainless". Holders of foreign manufacture shall bear the name of the country of manufactuer.

Workmanship. The suture needle holder shall be free from burrs, cracks, grind marks or other defects which detract from its appearance or impair its serviceability.

Unit. Each (EA). One suture neddle holder, as specified, constitutes one unit.

Quality Assurance Provisions.

Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the contractor may use his own or any facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

Records. Records of examinations and tests performed by or for the contractor shall be maintained by the contractor and made available to the Government upon the Government's request, at any time, or from time to time, during the performance of the contract and for a period of three years after delivery of the supplies to which such records relate.

Inspection. Inspection, as used herein, is defined as both examination (such as visual or auditory investigation without the use of special laboratory appliances or procedures) and testing (determination by technical means of physical and chemical properties) of the item.

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Tests. Tests shall be conducted to determine compliance with specification requirements and as specified herein. Where feasible, the same sample shall be used for the determination of two or more test characteristics.

Locking test. The locking mechanism of the holder shall be tested for proper function by exerting a slight direct pressure (not lateral pressure) at the serrated portions of the handles. The pressure shall be exerted with the use of one hand, utilizing the thumb and forefinger or middle finger. The lock mechanism components shall be observed for proper and positive holding action and the jaws shall be observed for proper closure. The handles of holder shall then be depressed (in the same manner specified above) and the lock shall be observed for easy disengagement and jaw separation.

Sampling for examination. Sampling for examination shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105, with an AQL of 1.0 (percent defective) and an Inspection level of II. Unit of product for examination purposes shall be one complete forceps. Defects shall be those listed below.

Defects

Suture needle holder not free from cracks, pits, burrs, sharp edges, scale, rough area or corrosion.

Finish of the holder not as specified.

Style, design and dimensions not as specified.

Sampling for tests. Sampling for tests shall be conducted in accordance with MIL-STD-105 and as specified herein. The inspection level shall be S-2. Dimensional testing shall be at a 2.5% AQL, hardness testing at a 1.5% AQL, boil, copper sulfate, and jaw and lock test at a 1.0% AQL. The unit of product for test purposes shall be one needle suture holder.

Contractor certification. The contractor shall certify that the product offered meets the salient characteristics of this description and conforms to the producers' own drawings, specifications, standards, and quality assurance practices. The Government reserves the right to require proof of such conformance prior to first delivery and thereafter as may be otherwise provided for under the provisions of the contract.

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Metric products. Products manufactured to metric dimensions will be considered on an equal basis with those manufactured using inch-pound units, providing they fall within the tolerances specified using conversion tables contained in the latest revision of Federal Standard No. 376, and all other requirements of this document are met.

If a product is manufactured to metric dimensions and those dimensions exceed the tolerances specified in the inch/pound units, a request should be made to the contracting officer to determine if the product is acceptable.

The contracting officer has the option of accepting or rejecting the product.

Regulatory requirements.

Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act. If the product covered by this document has been determined by the U.S. Food and Drug Administration to be under its jurisdiction, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of the Federal Food, Drug and Cosmetic Act, as amended, and regulations promulgated thereunder. In addition, the offeror/contractor shall comply, and be responsible for compliance by its subcontractors/suppliers, with the requirements of all other applicable Federal, State, and local statutes, ordinances, and regulations.

Recovered materials. The offeror/contractor is encouraged to use recovered material in accordance with Public Law 94-580, as amended, and as implemented by Federal Acquisition Regulation Subpart 23.4 to the maximum extent practical.

Preservation, packaging, packing, labeling, and marking. Unless otherwise specified, preservation, packaging, and packing shall be to a degree of protection to preclude damage to containers and/or contents thereof under normal shipping conditions, handling, etc., involving shipment from the supply source to the receiving activity, plus reshipment from receiving activity, and shall conform to applicable carrier's rules and regulations. Intermediate and exterior package quantities and labeling and marking shall be as specified in the contract and/or order.

NOTE: The following National Stock Number is covered by this document:

NSN	ITEM IDENTIFICATION
6515-01-139-7667	HOLDER, SUTURE NEEDLE, Curved, 134 mm Long, Delicate 9 mm Jaws

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Ordering data (Intermediate/exterior package quantities and labeling and marking must be specified in the contract and/or order).

MILITARY INTERESTS:

Custodians:

Army - MD
Navy - MS
Air Force - 03

Preparing Activity:

DoD-MB

Agent:

DLA-DM

CIVIL AGENCY COORDINATING ACTIVITIES:

VA-OSS
PHS
FDA-MPQAS

PGC 59192

Project No. 6515-4585

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